

Interview-Oriented Business Scenarios – Solutions

Q1. Calculate the Total Revenue for the North Region

Dataset

Region Revenue

North 50000

South 35000

North 75000

Formula

=SUMIF(B2:B100,"North",H2:H100)

Or

=SUMIFS(H2:H100,B2:B100,"North")

Answer

Adds the revenue of all rows where Region = North.

Q2. Count Customers Whose Revenue is Greater Than ₹50,000

Formula

=COUNTIF(H2:H100,">50000")

Or

=COUNTIFS(H2:H100,">50000")

Answer

Counts all orders having revenue greater than ₹50,000.

Q3. Categorize Revenue into High, Medium and Low

Formula

=IFS(H2>100000,"High",H2>=50000,"Medium",TRUE,"Low")

Alternative

=IF(H2>100000,"High",IF(H2>=50000,"Medium","Low"))

Answer

Revenue >100000 → High

Revenue 50000–100000 → Medium

Else → Low

Q4. Give Bonus if Revenue >100000 and Profit >20%

Formula

=IF(AND(H2>100000,I2>20),"Bonus","No Bonus")

Answer

Checks both conditions simultaneously.

Q5. Campaign for North OR West Region

Formula

=IF(OR(B2="North",B2="West"),"Campaign","No Campaign")

Answer

Returns Campaign if either condition is true.

Q6. Standardize Customer Names

Raw Data

rahul SHARMA

Formula

=PROPER(TRIM(A2))

Answer

Removes spaces and converts to Proper Case.

Q7. Extract Email Username and Domain

Email

rahul@gmail.com

Username

=LEFT(B2,FIND("@",B2)-1)

Domain

=MID(B2,FIND("@",B2)+1,LEN(B2))

Alternative

=RIGHT(B2,LEN(B2)-FIND("@",B2))

Q8. Clean Phone Numbers

Phone

98765-43210

Formula

=SUBSTITUTE(A2,"-","")

If spaces also exist

=SUBSTITUTE(SUBSTITUTE(A2,"-","")," ","")

Answer

Produces

9876543210

Q9. Extract Month and Year

Month

=MONTH(A2)

Year

=YEAR(A2)

Answer

Returns month number and year separately.

Q10. Identify Weekend Orders

Formula

=IF(WEEKDAY(A2,2)>5,"Weekend","Weekday")

Answer

Saturday and Sunday become Weekend.



Q11. Lookup Employee Department

Preferred

=XLOOKUP(A2,EmployeeID,Department,"Not Found")

Alternative

=VLOOKUP(A2,A2:D100,3,FALSE)

Answer

Returns department using Employee ID.

Q12. Lookup Product Price using INDEX + MATCH

Formula

=INDEX(C2:C100,MATCH(A2,A2:A100,0))

Answer

Returns product price based on Product ID.

Q13. Dynamic South Region Report

Formula

=FILTER(A2:H100,B2:B100="South")

Answer

Displays only South Region records dynamically.

Q14. Create Unique Customer List

Formula

=UNIQUE(A2:A100)

Answer

Returns each customer only once.

Q15. Sort Products by Revenue

Formula

=SORT(A2:H100,8,-1)

or

=SORTBY(A2:H100,H2:H100,-1)

Answer

Sorts data in descending order of Revenue.

Q16. Restrict Status Values

Steps

Data



Data Validation



List



Source

Completed,Pending,Cancelled

Answer

Only these values can be entered.

Q17. Highlight High and Low Revenue

High Revenue Rule

Condition

Greater Than

100000

Color

Green

Low Revenue Rule

Condition

Less Than

50000

Color

Red

Answer

Helps management identify important transactions quickly.

Q18. Replace #N/A with Product Not Found

Formula

=IFERROR(XLOOKUP(A2,ProductID,Price),"Product Not Found")

Alternative

=IFERROR(VLOOKUP(A2,A2:D100,3,FALSE),"Product Not Found")

Answer

Displays a user-friendly message instead of an error.

Q19. Complete Data Cleaning Workflow

Step 1

Remove extra spaces

=TRIM(A2)

Step 2

Convert Proper Case

=PROPER(A2)

Step 3

Convert emails to lowercase

=LOWER(B2)

Step 4

Clean phone numbers

=SUBSTITUTE(SUBSTITUTE(C2,"-","")," ","")

Step 5

Convert Revenue into Number

=VALUE(SUBSTITUTE(D2,"",""))



Step 6

Remove duplicates

Data → Remove Duplicates

Step 7

Standardize dates

Format Cells → Date

Step 8

Fill missing values

Use appropriate values or investigate the source.

Step 9

Validate Status

Completed

Pending

Cancelled

Final Result

Dataset becomes analysis-ready.

Q20. Complete Business Workflow

Scenario

You receive an unclean sales dataset from the client and need to prepare a monthly revenue report.

Expected Workflow

Step 1: Understand the dataset and business objective.

Step 2: Create a backup of the raw data.

Step 3: Identify missing values, duplicates, inconsistent formats, and invalid entries.

Step 4: Clean the data:

- TRIM() for extra spaces
- PROPER(), UPPER(), LOWER() for text standardization
- SUBSTITUTE() and REPLACE() for unwanted characters
- VALUE() for numbers stored as text
- Standardize date formats

Step 5: Validate data using Data Validation lists where applicable.

Step 6: Handle formula errors using IFERROR().

Step 7: Use lookup functions (XLOOKUP(), INDEX()+MATCH()) to enrich the dataset.

Step 8: Apply Dynamic Array functions (FILTER(), UNIQUE(), SORT()) for dynamic reporting.

Step 9: Use Aggregate Functions (SUMIFS(), COUNTIFS(), AVERAGEIFS()) to calculate KPIs.

Step 10: Apply Conditional Formatting to highlight key insights.

Step 11: Build Pivot Tables and Dashboards to summarize and visualize the cleaned data.

Step 12: Deliver the final report with key business insights and recommendations.

💡 Interview Tip



<https://www.linkedin.com/in/the-venom/>

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For scenario-based interviews, don't jump straight to formulas. Start by explaining **your approach** (understanding the business problem, cleaning the data, validating it, analyzing it, and then presenting insights). Interviewers often evaluate your analytical workflow as much as your Excel formula knowledge.



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